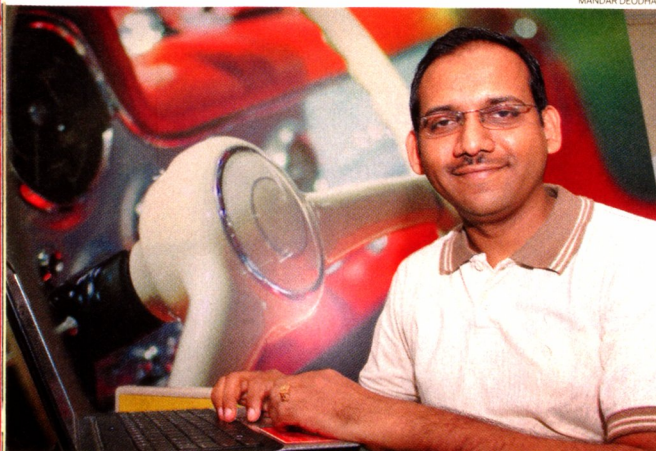


MANDAR DEODHAR



"WE HAVE CREATED A SET OF PARAMETERS WHICH HELP people arrive at the fair value of their vehicle."

ARUN SAHLAM, CARWALE.COM, 31

If you are planning to buy a car and cannot make up your mind, chances are you haven't visited Carwale.com. The portal has answers for all consumers' needs. Born in a small town near Jabalpur, Arun Sahlam and his partners Gaurav Verma, 31, and Mohit Dubey, 35, understand the importance of empowering customers with relevant information through technology. Their first assignment was to manage the pre-owned car inventory for a used-car dealer in Mumbai. They tried to connect all the dealerships with a web interface so that they could trade among themselves and serve customers with a better inventory. But no dealership used it. They then decided to bring all the used car stock directly to car buyers. Thus was born Carwale.com. Says Sahlam: "Since car information was not available easily, we started offering comparisons and user reviews to empower our visitors." By then, Rs 6 lakh had been invested in the venture, which was not making money initially. As traffic increased, automobile manufacturers began to advertise on the website. In just over three years,

Success Graph

Carwale has facilitated 10 million Indian car consumers and influenced approximately \$3 billion worth of car transactions in the country.

from being a pilot project, Carwale has turned into a profitable venture. It has won many awards, including the *Red Herring* Asia Top 100 and *BusinessWeek's* Top 25 Young Entrepreneurs in Asia. In three years, Sahlam hopes to list the company once its revenues touch Rs 100 crore. **by Malini Bhupta**



RANJAN RAH

"MOST OF MY PEERS DISCOURAGED ME.

They said people would not gift puja items for Diwali. But I proved them wrong."

PRAKASH MUNDHRA, SACRED MOMENTS, 29

